Furkan Kilic

Associate Economist, Development Economics Private Markets, World Bank Group

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Professional Experience

Associate Economist, DECPM, World Bank Group 2026–present

Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Economics, University of Chicago 2024–2026

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Chicago 2024

M.A. in Economics, University of Chicago 2020

M.Sc. in Economics, Koc University 2018

B.A. in Economics, TOBB University of Economics & Technology 2016

With distinction — 1st in college, 2nd university-wide.

B.A. in International Relations, TOBB University of Economics & Technology *(dual degree)* 2016

Research

Spatial Allocation of Inventors, Knowledge Diffusion and Growth

Engineering Ukraine's Wirtschaftswunder *(with Ufuk Akcigit, Somik Lall, and Solomiya Shpak)*. NBER Working Paper No. 34103; World Bank Policy Research Working Paper No. 11174.

Technology Gaps, Competition, and Regional Convergence *(with Ufuk Akcigit, Sina Ates, Matthias Mertens, and Steffen Mueller)*

Work in Progress

The Inequality–Growth Nexus: Evidence and Theory from Capital Goods Innovation

Measuring Productivity, Business Dynamism, and Economic Growth: The Case of Colombia and Türkiye *(with Ufuk Akcigit, Maria Aristizabal-Ramirez, Seyit Cilasun, Christian Posso, and Andres Zambrano)*

High-Growth Firms and the Demand for Skills: Evidence from Job Postings *(with Anuraag Aekka, Ufuk Akcigit, Roberto Fattal Jaef, and Tatjana Kleineberg)*

Productivity Dynamics Framework *(with Ufuk Akcigit and Sina Ates)*

Superstar Spillovers: Productivity Gains and Sales Reallocation *(with Okan Akarsu, Barbaros Eris, and Alper Yildirim)*

Increasing Returns in AI Production: Endogenous Concentration and Adoption *(with Ufuk Akcigit and Geraud Desazars)*

Conferences & Presentations

Urban Economics Association Conference, Chicago Fed	September 2026
Growth Academy, University of Chicago	July 2026
Halle Institute for Economic Research (IWH), Halle, Germany	June 2026
Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings, Milwaukee	May 2026
24th Annual International Industrial Organization Conference, Boston	April 2026
TED University, Ankara, Türkiye	November 2025
World Bank, Washington, DC	September 2025
Growth Academy, University of Chicago	July 2025
Macroeconomics Across Time and Space, Philadelphia Fed	October 2024
Capital Theory Seminar, University of Chicago	2024, 2025
Applications of Economics Seminar, University of Chicago	2023

Professional Service

Organizer	Growth Academy	2024–2026
	ART Seminars, University of Chicago	2023–2026
Discussant	"Safety in Unemployment and Risky Experimentation of Young Firms"	2026
	"The Geography of Research: The Trade-Off Between Knowledge Production and Access"	2026
Refereeing	American Economic Review: Insights	
	Economics Letters	
	Journal of the European Economic Association	

Awards, Scholarships & Honors

University of Chicago Neubauer Fellowship	2018–2024
Republic of Türkiye TUBITAK Fellowship	2016–2018
Koc University Graduate Scholarship	2016–2018
Prime Ministry Outstanding Achievement Scholarship	2010–2015
59th out of 1.5 million candidates (top 0.004%), Turkish National University Entrance Exam	2010

Teaching Experience

Course (Level)	Position	Term
Firm Dynamics and Growth (graduate)	TA for Ufuk Akcigit	Winter 2022, 2023
Economic Policy Analysis (undergraduate)	TA for Kanit Kuevibulvanich	Fall 2022, 2023
Elements of Economic Analysis (undergraduate)	TA for Suleyman Gozen	Spring 2020
Macroeconomics I (graduate)	TA for Kamil Yilmaz	Fall 2017
Math Camp (graduate)	Instructor	Summer 2017
Money and Banking (undergraduate)	TA for Selva Demiralp	Spring 2017
Introduction to Economics (undergraduate)	TA for Murat Usman	Fall 2016

Research Assistantships

Research Assistant for Ufuk Akcigit, University of Chicago	2019–2021
Research Assistant for Sumru Altug and Sevcan Yesiltas, Koc University	2017–2018

Programming & Software

Julia, Stata, Python, Polars, PySpark on Databricks, R, SQL

Languages & Citizenship

Languages Turkish (native), English (fluent)

Citizenship Türkiye